

Brain Food

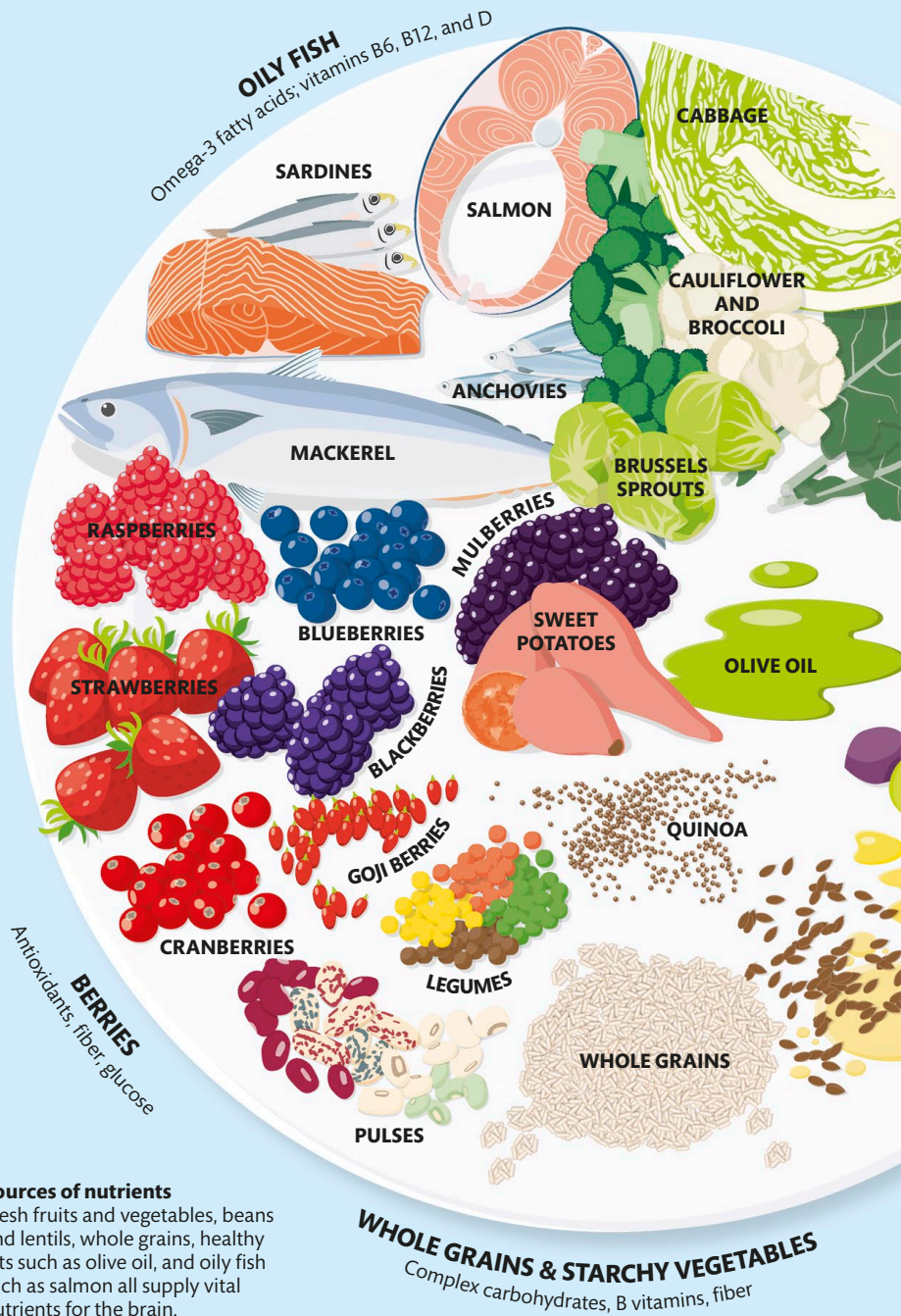
Like any other organ, the human brain needs a constant supply of water and nutrients to maintain its health and to supply energy for efficient functioning.

Feeding the brain

A healthy diet benefits both the mind and the body. Complex carbohydrates provide a steady flow of fuel; these are found in whole grain bread, brown rice, legumes, potatoes, and sweet potatoes. Healthy fats are essential for maintaining brain cells, and these fats come from oily fish, vegetable oils, and plant foods such as avocados and flaxseeds. Proteins supply amino acids. Fruits and vegetables supply water, vitamins, and fiber.

HYDRATION

Brain cells need adequate hydration (water supply) in order to function effectively. Studies have shown that dehydration can impair our ability to concentrate and to perform mental tasks and negatively affect memory. Some of our water intake comes from the food we consume, but it is helpful to drink several glasses of water each day to maintain a healthy level of hydration.



Sources of nutrients

Fresh fruits and vegetables, beans and lentils, whole grains, healthy fats such as olive oil, and oily fish such as salmon all supply vital nutrients for the brain.